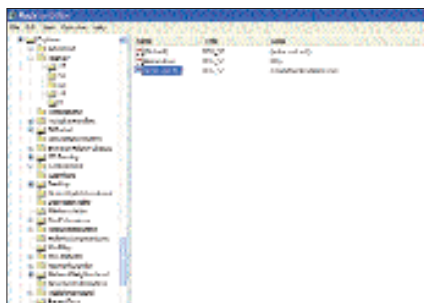


Change The Internet Key's Functionality

Almost all keyboards, cheap or costly, come with special keys including an Internet key. You can choose to make that key load another application instead of the browser. (The keyboard drivers often provide this capability, but sometimes they don't.)

To change this, in the Registry Editor, go to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Appkey\7`. Create a new String Value by right-clicking in the right pane and selecting **New > String Value**. Enter the name as "ShellExecute". Double-click on the newly-created String Value and enter the Value as the path of the file you want to run when you press the Internet Key. Click OK.



Changing key functions

Enable The Windows ZIP tool

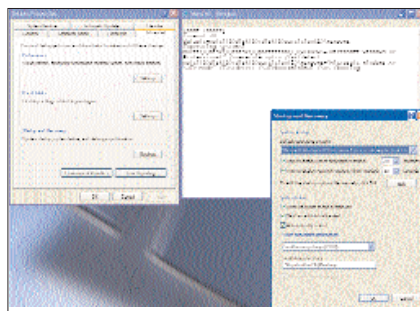
Windows XP comes built in with a compression tool that reads ZIP files as folders. When you install Windows, you can open ZIP files using that tool. Then, say you install WinZip or WinRAR, and then uninstall it. You'll then need to re-enable the inbuilt ZIP file reader.

To enable Windows ZIP files as a folder feature again, you can use a simple command. At a command prompt, enter "regsvr32 %windir%\system32\zipfldr.dll". Press [Enter].

Adding Safe Mode To Your Boot List

At times you might need to switch to Safe Mode to fix a problem such as a virus infection or uninstalling drivers. You can add an entry to the boot list. To do this, go to **Control Panel > System** (or simply press [Windows] + [Pause/Break]). Click on the Advanced tab. Then, click on the Settings button under the Startup and Recovery section. Click on Edit under System Startup to indirectly edit the boot.ini file. Add the following entry: `multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(2)\WINDOWS="Microsoft Windows XP - Safe Mode" /fastdetect /safeboot:minimal /sos /bootlog`

You can add more entries if needed to boot any Windows installations on other disks or partitions.

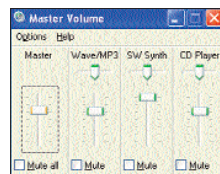


Add Safe Mode to the boot options

A Prettier Volume Control

Few people know that the Volume Control has a hidden, compact-looking profile. You can create a shortcut with the command as "sndvol32 /s" or by pressing [Ctrl] + [S] with the Windows Volume Control running. Press [Ctrl] + [S] again to revert to the original size.

To open a minimal volume control with only the single slider, you can create a shortcut by first right-clicking at the location you want to add the shortcut, then click **New > Shortcut**, and type in "sndvol32 /t".



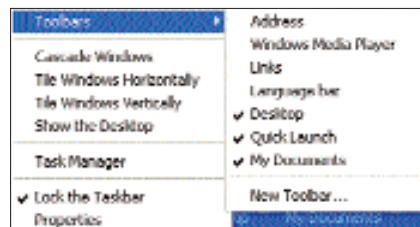
A small Volume Control

Remove Default Shared Folders

Windows XP comes with a shared folder called Shared Documents which is visible when you open My Computer. You can remove the folder by removing a key in the Registry. (You might want to do this because, for example, viruses can end up there through an infected network.) Browse to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\MyComputer\NameSpace\DelegateFolders\`. Here, delete the key with the name "{59031a47-3f72-44a7-89c5-5595fe6b30ee}". The shared folder will disappear.

Access Desktop From Taskbar

One of the easiest ways to access programs is to use Quick Launch. In the cases of My Documents or Desktop icons, it's not possible to copy all these into the Quick Launch; instead, right-click on the taskbar, click on Toolbars, and choose Desktop. Your Desktop will appear on the taskbar. Now you no



Access the Desktop from the Taskbar

longer have to minimise all your windows to access items on the desktop.

Similarly, you can also first create a folder with a suitable name with shortcuts for your favourite programs. Next, right-click on the taskbar and then on **Toolbars > New Toolbar**. Point to the folder containing your shortcuts and click OK.

Automatically Terminate Hung Programs

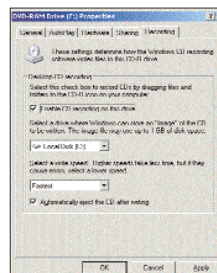
When programs lock up or stop responding, you are forced to [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Delete] > End Process. This tweak lets Windows automatically shut down hung programs. In the Registry Editor, browse to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop`. You will find a String Value called **AutoEndTasks**. Double-click on it and change the value to "1". You can also set the timeout value by double-clicking on the **WaitToKillAppTimeout** String Value and changing its value to the time in milliseconds before Windows kills the task.

Disable The Windows CD Writing Function

Windows XP comes with CD writing

software which can be used if you don't have any third-party program to do that. If you do use the third-party software, you can disable the inbuilt writing feature.

Go to My Computer. Right-click on your CD or DVD writer and click Properties. There, click on the Recording tab, and uncheck the box "Enable CD/DVD Recording on this drive".



Stop XP from writing your CDs

Disable Sending Of Windows Error Reports

When a program crashes, it gives you an error, then asks you to send an error report to Microsoft—which you usually abort or ignore. You can disable the popping up of the option altogether: [Windows] + [Pause/Break], click on the Advanced tab and then on the Error Reporting button. Here, you can click the Disable Error Reporting radio button, or choose the programs you want to exclude from getting the error reporting option. Click on Choose Programs to do this.

Add Additional Time Servers

Windows lets you synchronise your system clock with a server on the Internet. If you didn't know about it, double-click on the time and click on the Internet time tab. Check